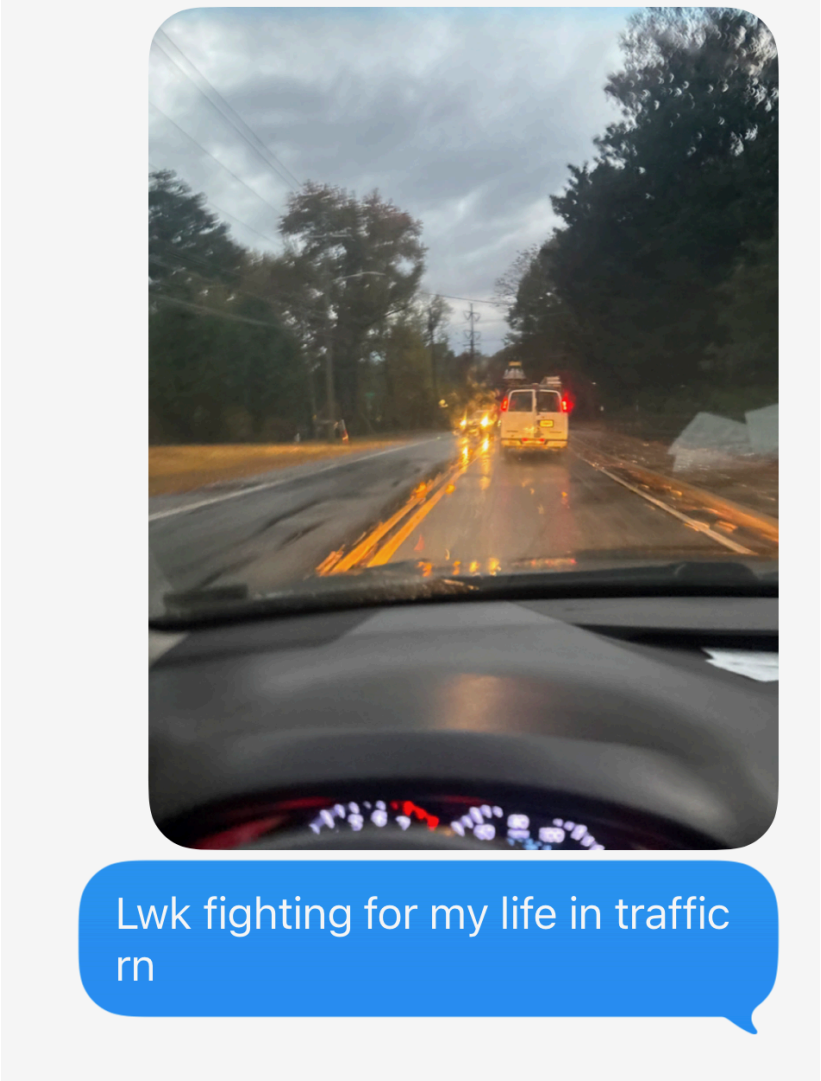
Figure 1

Running Late to a Meeting due to overflow of rush hour traffic

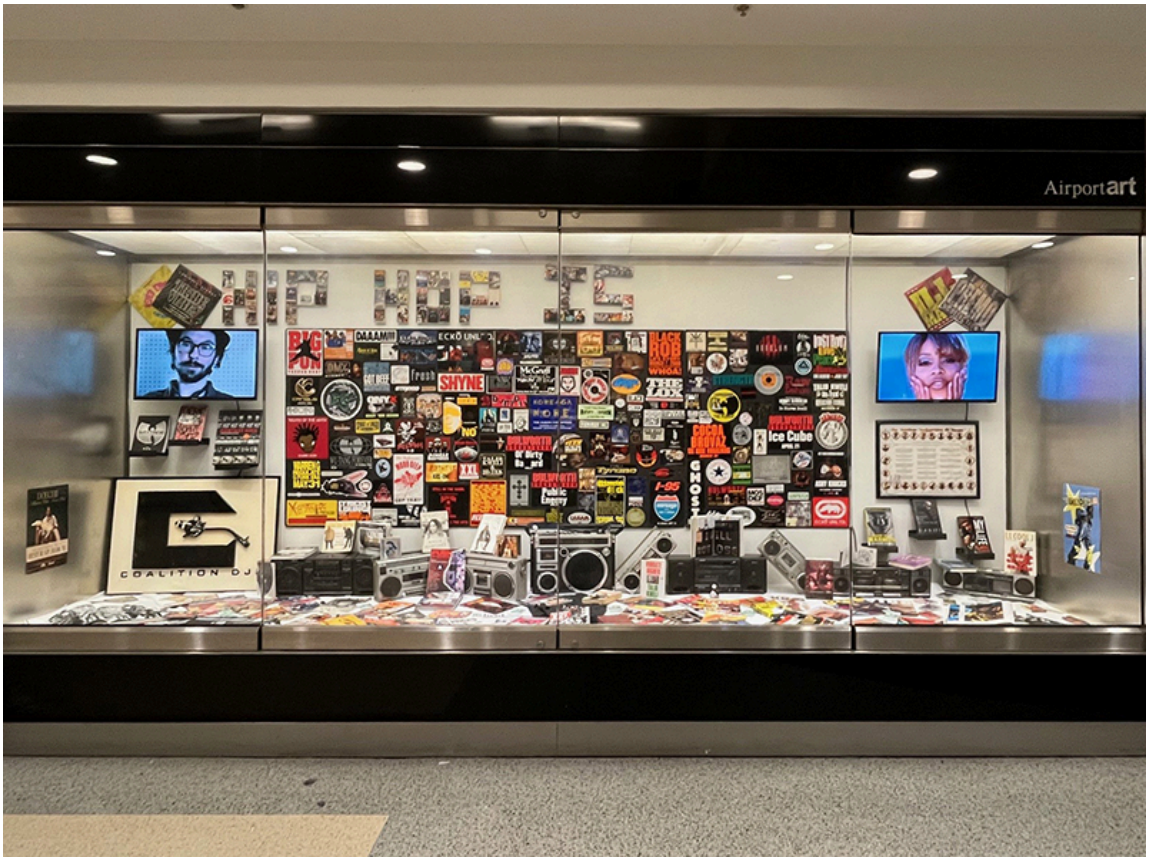


Note. By C. Kim, 2025, November 2, iPhone screenshot, taken during commute from off campus housing to Emory University, Atlanta, GA, United States.

The fragmentation of Atlanta's geography has resulted in the geographic isolation felt by many in the city. As a consequence of urban sprawl, “roughly 3 out of every 4 commuters in metro Atlanta” drive to work, unable to walk due to the city's isolated layout, (Thigpen, 2026). Regardless of class, Atlanta's traffic effects all of its residents and is a shared frustration of those living in the city.

Figure 2

"Hip Hop is Global"

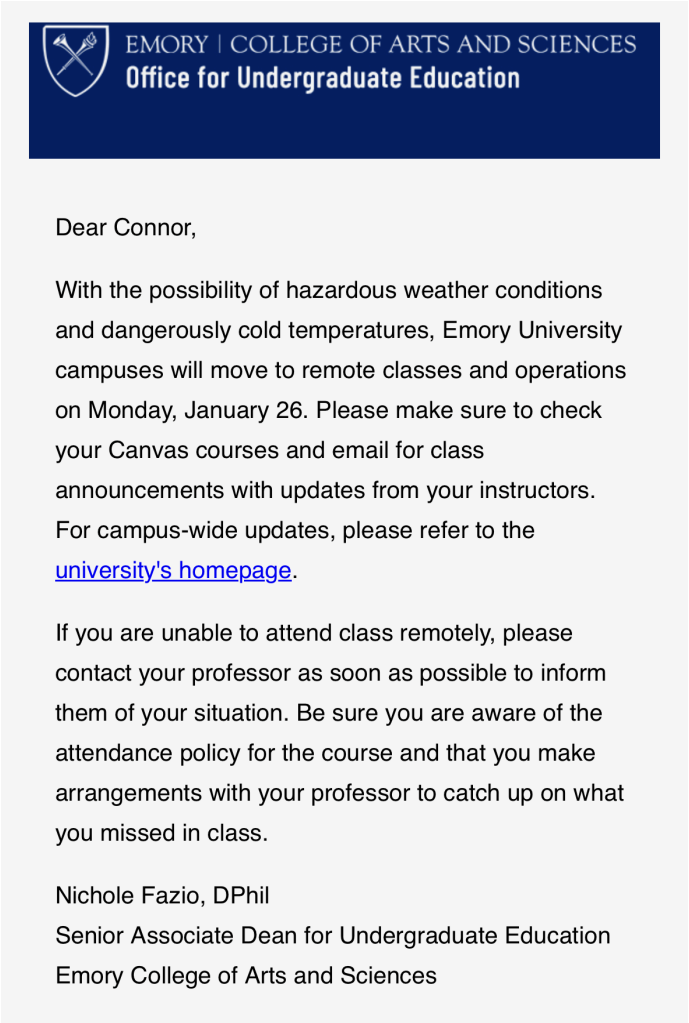


Note. By C. Fluker and M. McGavin, 2025, December 5, Displaying artifacts curated from the original Ear Wax Records store, Located on Concourse E, between gates E11 and E15 at the Hartsfield Jackson Atlanta International Airport in Atlanta, GA, United States.

Following the closure of the historically significant EarWax Records store in 2018, conservational efforts have been made to preserve the origin of hop hop in Atlanta (McCracken, 2018). While displaying the artifacts of the Ear Wax Records store marked significant progress in cementing Atlanta as one of the birthplaces of Hip Hop, the glass case is a powerful symbol of the cultural erasure occurring in the city, leaving Atlanta's true history behind a barrier to only be admired.

Figure 3

Emory University shutdown with no visible snow



EMORY | COLLEGE OF ARTS AND SCIENCES
Office for Undergraduate Education

Dear Connor,

With the possibility of hazardous weather conditions and dangerously cold temperatures, Emory University campuses will move to remote classes and operations on Monday, January 26. Please make sure to check your Canvas courses and email for class announcements with updates from your instructors. For campus-wide updates, please refer to the university's homepage.

If you are unable to attend class remotely, please contact your professor as soon as possible to inform them of your situation. Be sure you are aware of the attendance policy for the course and that you make arrangements with your professor to catch up on what you missed in class.

Nichole Fazio, DPhil
Senior Associate Dean for Undergraduate Education
Emory College of Arts and Sciences

Note. By C. Kim, 2026, January 5, iPhone screenshot, taken during Emory University's operational shutdown due to the possibility of snow, Atlanta, GA, United States.

While receiving a notification of Emory's closure due to snow is humorous, given its nickname “Hotlanta”, the panic that ensued following the prospect of snow, highlights a significant lack of infrastructure present in Atlanta. Narratives such as “Hotlanta” has led to the cities complacency in planning for cold weather and the consequences are often felt only after tragedy strikes, such as the 2014 Snowpocalypse, (Leoffler, 2024).

References

Leoffler, K. (2024, January 28). *Snowmageddon 10 years later: What Georgia has learned*. FOX 5 Atlanta. https://www.fox5atlanta.com/news/snowmageddon-10-years-later-what-georgia-has-learned

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McGavin, M. (2025, December 4). *Emory's Rose Library partners with Atlanta Airport for Earwax Records Hip Hop Exhibit: Emory University: Atlanta ga*. News. https://news.emory.edu/stories/2025/12/er_airport_hip_hop_exhibit_03-12-2025/story.html

Thigpen, M. (2026, January 16). *Why Atlanta roads are so deadly for black pedestrians - capital B news*. Atlanta. https://atlanta.capitalbnews.org/atlanta-pedestrian-deaths-exceed-homicides/